

// MISSION & POSITIONING

Who we are. What we sell.

This playbook is for the Ephemeral team — sales, recruiters, and ops. It defines how we talk, how we qualify, how we execute, and how we win.

// MISSION

Deploy elite engineers to high-growth startups — in 48 hours, not 6 weeks.

// POSITIONING

Precision staffing for Seed-to-Series C teams who need to ship, not hire.

// IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

Company stage

Seed to Series C. 5 to 200 engineers on staff. Backed, with budget authority.

Decision-maker

CTO, VP Engineering, or Head of Product. Feels the pain of slow hiring directly.

Trigger signals

New funding round, product launch sprint, team gap after departure, or scaling push.

// PROFILES WE STAFF

PROFILE	SPECIALIZATIONS	TYPICAL SENIORITY	AVG. ENGAGEMENT
Software Engineer	Backend, Frontend, Fullstack, Mobile, Rust, Go, Python, Node	Senior · Lead · Staff · CTO	3–6 months
Infra Engineer	Cloud (AWS/GCP/Azure), Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, Platform, Security	Senior · Lead · Staff	2–4 months
AI / Data Engineer	ML Engineering, MLOps, Data Engineering, LLM/RAG, Analytics, Python/Spark	Senior · Lead · Staff	3–6 months
Product Engineer	Product Engineers, Technical PM, Product Owner, PM/PO — embedded in teams	Senior · Lead · Staff	2–5 months

// COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

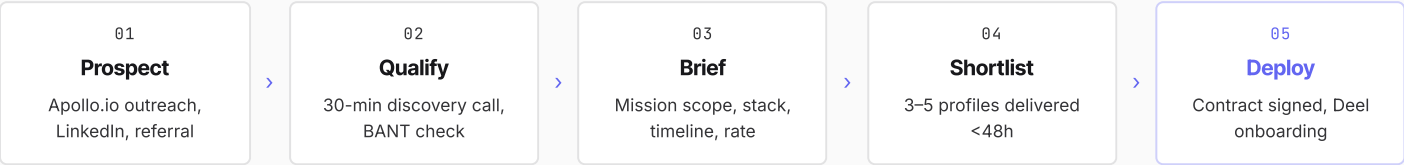
COMPETITOR	POSITIONING	WEAKNESS	OUR EDGE
Toptal	Premium freelance network, top 3%	Slow (1–2 weeks), expensive, rigid process	48h shortlist, senior-only, mission-fit
Turing	AI-matched remote engineers	Volume-first, weak seniority signal	Curated, 3-layer vetting, real references
Job boards	LinkedIn, Indeed, AngelList	DIY, 4–12 weeks, no vetting	Done-for-you, pre-vetted, immediate
Pragmatike	Claims 48h, CoderByte, Deel	Smaller network, limited LATAM/Africa depth	100K+ profiles, 10+ years network, 4 regions

// SALES PROCESS & QUALIFICATION

How we qualify and close.

Every deal starts with a mission brief. Our job is to qualify fast, pitch with precision, and deliver a shortlist that makes the decision easy.

// PIPELINE STAGES (PIPEDRIVE)



// QUALIFICATION CHECKLIST (BANT)

- B Budget:** Is there a contractor budget approved? Rate range? Monthly envelope?
- A Authority:** Are we talking to the CTO/VP Eng? Who signs the contract?
- N Need:** What's the specific gap? What does success look like in 90 days?
- T Timeline:** When do they need the engineer to start? Is there a hard deadline?

// DISQUALIFICATION SIGNALS

- × **No budget authority** — HR-only contact, no CTO/VP Eng involved
- × **Rate mismatch** — budget under \$40/h for senior profiles
- × **Permanent hire only** — no openness to contractor model
- × **Junior profiles** — we don't staff below senior level
- × **No urgency** — "maybe in 6 months" — move to nurture sequence

// OBJECTION HANDLING

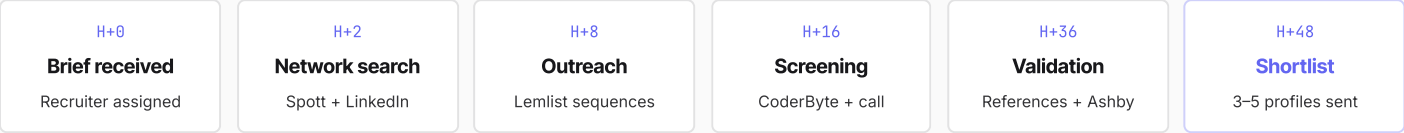
OBJECTION	RESPONSE
"We prefer to hire permanently."	"Absolutely — and we offer contractor-to-hire at 20%. You trial the engineer for 2–3 months, then convert. Zero risk, full optionality."
"48 hours sounds too fast to be real."	"It's our operational commitment, not a contractual SLA. We've built 10+ years of network depth specifically for this. Let us prove it with your first brief."
"We've had bad experiences with staffing."	"We hear that a lot. That's why we run a 3-layer vetting process — technical assessment, seniority validation, and mission fit interview — before any profile reaches you."
"Your rates are higher than job boards."	"Job boards take 6–12 weeks and deliver unvetted CVs. We deliver 3 pre-vetted senior engineers in 48 hours. The cost of a 2-month hiring cycle far exceeds our fee."

// RECRUITMENT PROCESS & VETTING

How we find and validate talent.

The 48h brief-to-shortlist commitment is our operational standard. This page defines the sourcing, vetting, and delivery workflow that makes it possible.

// 48H EXECUTION FLOW



// 3-LAYER VETTING PROTOCOL

- 01

Technical assessment — CoderByte
Stack-specific challenge (60–90 min). Evaluated on problem-solving approach and code quality. Minimum score threshold enforced per profile type. No whiteboard theatre.
- 02

Seniority validation
Reference checks (2 minimum), career track verification, and profile & background verification. We validate seniority-level autonomy, not just years of experience.
- 03

Mission fit interview
Structured interview covering communication, autonomy, remote-first mindset, and mission alignment. Validated before any profile is shortlisted.

// SOURCING CHANNELS

Primary network — Spott
100,000+ pre-screened profiles built over 10+ years via Skill Hunter. First search always starts here. Profiles already tagged by stack, seniority, region, and availability.

Active sourcing — LinkedIn Recruiter
Boolean search, InMail campaigns. Enriched via Fullenrich and ContactOut for direct email/phone. Sequences managed in Lemlist.

Inbound & referrals
Ashby ATS for inbound applications. Referral program active in LATAM and EMEA. Community partnerships in Senegal, Morocco, and Brazil.

// TALENT COVERAGE BY REGION

REGION	SHARE	KEY COUNTRIES	TIMEZONE OVERLAP (US/EU)	SOURCING NOTES
LATAM	45%	Brazil, Mexico, Argentina, Colombia, Chile	US EST/PST overlap: strong	Largest pool, strongest referral network, Brazil dominant
EMEA	30%	France, Spain, Poland, Morocco, Nigeria	EU overlap: excellent	Strong in backend/ML; Morocco growing fast
Africa	15%	Senegal, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Tunisia, Egypt	EU overlap: good	Fastest growing segment; strong in mobile and data
Asia	10%	India, Vietnam, Philippines, Indonesia	US PST overlap: partial	Niche profiles (ML, DevOps); selective sourcing

// PRICING, UNIT ECONOMICS & OPS

How we price. How we operate.

Internal pricing structure, unit economics, tech stack, and compliance framework. Not for client distribution.

// PRICING STRUCTURE (INTERNAL)

PROFILE TIER	CLIENT RATE (BILLED)	CONTRACTOR RATE (PAID)	MARKUP	MONTHLY GROSS (160H)
Software Engineer	\$85-120/h	\$65-92/h	~30%	\$13,600-19,200
Infra Engineer	\$80-110/h	\$62-85/h	~30%	\$12,800-17,600
AI / Data Engineer	\$90-130/h	\$69-100/h	~30%	\$14,400-20,800
Product Engineer	\$75-100/h	\$58-77/h	~30%	\$12,000-16,000
Contractor-to-hire	20% of first-year salary upon permanent conversion. Billed as one-time fee.			One-time

// UNIT ECONOMICS (PER ACTIVE CONTRACTOR)

Avg. billed rate	\$95/h
Avg. contractor rate	\$73/h
Gross margin / hour	\$22/h (~30%)
Monthly gross (160h)	\$3,520
Avg. engagement duration	3.5 months
LTV per placement	~\$12,320

// TECH STACK

TALENT Spott CoderByte LinkedIn Recruiter Ashby (ATS)	SALES Pipedrive (CRM) Apollo.io Lemlist Aircall
ENRICHMENT Fullenrich ContactOut	COMPLIANCE Deel (global payroll, contracts, compliance)

// COMPLIANCE & CONTRACTS (DEEL)

- **All contractors onboarded via Deel** — global payroll, local compliance, IP protection, and NDA in one flow.
- **Client MSA + SOW** — signed before any shortlist is delivered. Deel handles contractor agreements independently.
- **Contractor-to-hire** — 20% of first-year salary. Conversion clause included in MSA. Deel facilitates the transition to direct employment.
- **Payment terms** — Net 15 on weekly or bi-weekly timesheets. Deel auto-invoices the client and pays the contractor.

// BRAND VOICE RULES (FOR ALL COMMS)

USE mission · deploy · execute precision · firepower · elite liquid talent · sprint · ship senior · agility · scope	NEVER resource · outsourcing body shopping · offshore cheap · HR · collaborator EPHEMER (all caps)
Sentence case everywhere. Italic only on "<i>ephemera</i>". The tagline is: "Stop hiring for the decade. Hire for the sprint."	